

Prostate Specific Antigen

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

190.31

Manual Section Title

Prostate Specific Antigen

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

11/25/2002

Implementation Date

01/01/2003

Description Information

Benefit Category

Diagnostic Laboratory Tests

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

Prostate Specific Antigen (PSA), a tumor marker for adenocarcinoma of the prostate, can predict residual tumor in the post-operative phase of prostate cancer. Three to six months after radical prostatectomy, PSA is reported to provide a sensitive indicator of persistent disease. Six months following introduction of antiandrogen therapy, PSA is reported as capable of distinguishing patients with favorable response from those in whom limited response is anticipated.

PSA when used in conjunction with other prostate cancer tests, such as digital rectal examination, may assist in the decision making process for diagnosing prostate cancer. PSA also, serves as a marker in following the progress of most prostate tumors once a diagnosis has been established. This test is also an aid in the management of prostate cancer patients and in detecting metastatic or persistent disease in patients following treatment.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

Indications

PSA is of proven value in differentiating benign from malignant disease in men with lower urinary tract signs and symptoms (e.g., hematuria, slow urine stream, hesitancy, urgency, frequency, nocturia and incontinence) as well as with patients with palpably abnormal prostate glands on physician exam, and in patients with other laboratory or imaging studies that suggest the possibility of a malignant prostate disorder. PSA is also a marker used to follow the progress of prostate cancer once a diagnosis has been established, such as in detecting metastatic or persistent disease in patients who may require additional treatment. PSA testing may also be useful in the differential diagnosis of men presenting with as yet undiagnosed disseminated metastatic disease.

Limitations

Generally, for patients with lower urinary tract signs or symptoms, the test is performed only once per year unless there is a change in the patient's medical condition.

Testing with a diagnosis of in situ carcinoma is not reasonably done more frequently than once, unless the result is abnormal, in which case the test may be repeated once.

Note: Scroll down for links to the quarterly Covered Code Lists (including narrative).

Cross Reference

Also see the [Medicare Claims Processing Manual](#)[↗], Chapter 120, Clinical Laboratory Services Based on Negotiated Rulemaking.

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

17

Coverage Transmittal Link

Revision History

07/2004 - Published NCD in the NCD Manual without change to narrative contained in PM AB-02-110. Coding guidance now published in Medicare Lab NCD Manual. Effective and Implementation dates NA. ([TN 17](#)) (CR 2130)

07/2002 - Implemented NCD. Effective date 11/25/02. Implementation date 1/01/03. ([TN AB-02-110](#)) (CR 2130)

Other

Covered Code Lists (including narrative)

January 2026 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

October 2025 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

January 2025 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

October 2024 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

July 2024 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

April 2024 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

January 2024 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

October 2023 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

July 2023 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

April 2023 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

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July 2018 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

April 2018 (PDF) ([ICD-10](#))

January 2018 ([ICD-10](#))

October 2017 ([ICD-10](#))

July 2017 ([ICD-10](#))

April 2017 ([ICD-10](#))

[January 2017 \(ICD-10 !\[\]\(125d701e9425b54c764340b5671b38cd_img.jpg\)\)](#)
[October 2016 \(ICD-10 !\[\]\(34c5d6a15de5cee4fef2fa4252527f03_img.jpg\)\)](#)
[January 2016 \(ICD-10 !\[\]\(5b11d5c5e33a434b0685002e20a1170c_img.jpg\)\)](#)
[October 2015 \(ICD-10 !\[\]\(10f6aa8ae083baccdee37269dc116db7_img.jpg\), ICD-9 !\[\]\(67f65dd05d2670f2db9b01bfccacc360_img.jpg\)\)](#)
[October 2014 \(ICD-10 !\[\]\(0d43ed44fe7910f081e2ca410dc8c6a3_img.jpg\), ICD-9 !\[\]\(b5a5d544dd3fa74fe581b2f50f1e97a6_img.jpg\)\)](#)

Changes to Lab NCD Edit Software

[January 2026 !\[\]\(2bdfe261b986065ee0ac76460d6528c9_img.jpg\)](#)
[October 2025 !\[\]\(eebbd3dc1abeccf4c1e5751ec03fc559_img.jpg\)](#)
[January 2025 !\[\]\(269a46bd9f0c528dd4b0b2018aec306d_img.jpg\)](#)
[October 2024 !\[\]\(ca9b99849d19f75ed2add026e1deb81c_img.jpg\)](#)
[July 2024 !\[\]\(1865c2bd424e834c12e99dc58af6eb34_img.jpg\)](#)
[January 2024 !\[\]\(37943d3faa5342f3283296331f05e9fc_img.jpg\)](#)
[October 2023 !\[\]\(2403e633c7f08a0b6dc56871eda52870_img.jpg\)](#)
[April 2023 !\[\]\(00b8bd33f7be63a40d25dc8fe0a7159b_img.jpg\)](#)
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[October 2014 !\[\]\(c5d0ad1805e154522007c429f82898e6_img.jpg\)](#)

Coding Analyses for Labs (CALs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with CALs, from the Coding Analyses for Labs database.

- [Original Consideration for Prostate Specific Antigen \(Inclusion of ICD-9-CM Code 600.01 for BPH with Urine Obstruction\) \(CAG-00232N\) !\[\]\(4c660a3c4ce1da3313488b7854f55083_img.jpg\)](#)

- [Original Consideration for Codes That Are Not Covered by Medicare \(Removal of ICD-9-CM Code V76.44, Prostate Cancer Screening, From the List\) \(CAG-00297N\)](#)
- [Original Consideration for Prostate Specific Antigen \(Addition of ICD-9-CM 600.00, Hypertrophy \(benign\) of Prostate Without Urinary Obstruction, as a covered indication\) \(CAG-00326N\)](#)
- [Original Consideration for PSA \(Addition of ICD-9-CM 600.10, Nodular prostate without urinary obstruction and 600.11, with urinary obstruction, as covered indications\) \(CAG-00331N\)](#)
- [Original Consideration for PSA \(Addition of ICD-9-CM 600.21, Benign localized hyperplasia of prostate with urinary obstruction as a covered indication\) \(CAG-00332N\)](#)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Prostate Specific Antigen	1	11/25/2002 - N/A	You are here